AI Workflow Setup Guide

Freelancer Client Intelligence Agent

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01. Welcome

Welcome, and thanks for your purchase! 🎉

This is your AI-powered freelance client assistant — a system that lives inside Telegram and does the boring pre-client grunt work for you:

- 🔍 Finds potential clients by niche + location
- 🕵️ Researches them (website, what they do, contact details, social links)
- ✍️ Drafts personalized outreach emails in your voice
- ✅ Sends them — but only after you tap "Approve"
- 📇 Tracks every lead in a spreadsheet CRM
- ⏰ Reminds you to follow up automatically
- 📞 Preps you before discovery calls

Everything runs from your Telegram chat. You talk to it like a normal assistant. Setup takes about 30 minutes, and normal usage costs $0–5/month (all services have free tiers).

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02. Before You Begin

Who this is for: Freelancers who find their own clients. No coding required — just follow the steps in order.

What this can and cannot do (please read — honesty first):

✅ It can:

- Discover real businesses from Google's live data
- Read public website content
- Capture emails, phone numbers, and social links that appear publicly on a website
- Draft and send emails (with your approval)

❌ It cannot:

- Read *inside* LinkedIn / Instagram / Facebook profiles (those require login — no tool can legally do this)
- Bypass paywalls or logins
- Send any email without you approving it first
- Invent data — if something isn't publicly available, it tells you so instead of guessing

You'll bring your own free API keys. This keeps you in full control and means there are no monthly fees to us.

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03. Included Files

Your download contains 9 workflow files (`.json`) plus this guide:

#	File	What it does
1	`Main-Bot.json`	The conversational assistant (the brain)
2	`Save-Lead.json`	Saves a lead to your CRM
3	`Scrape-Contact.json`	Pulls emails & social links from a website
4	`Send-Email-Approval.json`	Sends outreach after your approval
5	`Update-Lead-Status.json`	Marks leads won/lost/talked-to
6	`Save-Profile.json`	Stores your business profile
7	`Follow-up-Reminders.json`	Daily automatic follow-up nudges

8	`Discovery-Call-Prep.json`	Preps you before calls
9	`Error-Notifier.json`	Alerts you if anything breaks

Plus: `Setup-Guide.md` (this file).

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04. Required Accounts

Create these first (all free to start):

Service	Purpose	Free tier
Telegram	Where you chat with the bot	Free
OpenAI	The AI brain	~$5 credit lasts a long time
Google Cloud	Finds leads (Places API)	$200 free credits for 90 days .Requires card to activate
Google Sheets	Your lead CRM	Free
Gmail	Sends your outreach	Free

ScrapingBee *(optional)*	Reads JS-heavy sites (Wix, Squarespace) ,only if regular scraping fails	~1,000 free credits
Jina AI Reader	Reads websites that block normal scrapers	Free, no signup needed

You'll also need a credit card for Google Cloud (required to activate, but the free tier covers normal use).

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05. Installing n8n

This system runs on n8n (the automation platform). Two options:

Option A — n8n Cloud (easiest, recommended)

1. Go to n8n.io → Start free trial
2. Create your workspace
3. Done — you're ready to import

Option B — Self-hosted (advanced)

- Follow the official guide at docs.n8n.io/hosting
- Note: self-hosting requires you to set up your own Google OAuth client for Gmail/Sheets (Cloud handles this for you)

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06. Importing the Workflow

1. In n8n, go to Workflows
2. Click Add workflow → ··· (top-right menu) → Import from File
3. Select and import each of the 9 JSON files, one at a time
4. ⚠️ Do NOT activate any of them yet — we configure first, activate last

After importing, some nodes will show a red credential missing warning. This is normal. Your API keys are not inside the JSON file for security. You will attach your own credentials in Section 07.

06.5 Connect the Workflows Together

When you import the JSON files, n8n gives them new internal IDs. The Main Bot still points to the old IDs, so you must reconnect the 5 sub-workflows.

1. Open the Main Bot workflow in the n8n editor

2. Find these 5 tool nodes: save_profile, find_contact, save_lead, send_email, update_lead_status

3. Click into each "Execute Workflow" node

4. In the "Workflow" dropdown, you may see a weird ID or blank space. Ignore it.

5. Select the matching workflow by its NAME from the list:

- save_profile → select "Freelancer Agent — Save Profile"

- find_contact → select "Freelancer Agent — Scrape Contact"

- save_lead → select "Freelancer Agent — Save Lead"

- send_email → select "Freelancer Agent — Send Email with Approval"

- update_lead_status → select "Freelancer Agent — Update Lead Status"

6. Save the Main Bot workflow

Note: find_leads and fetch_website are HTTP Request nodes that call Google Places and websites directly. They only need credentials — no re-selection needed.

⚠️ Skip this step and the bot will say "Workflow could not be started" when you try to save a lead or send an email.

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07. Credentials Setup

You'll create these credential entries once, then attach them to nodes. In n8n go to Credentials → New for each:

Credential	Type to choose
Telegram	Telegram API
OpenAI	OpenAI
Google Maps	Header Auth (not "API key"!)
Google Sheets	Google Sheets OAuth2
Gmail	Gmail OAuth2
ScrapingBee *(optional)*	Query Auth

Details for each are in the next sections. 👇

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08. Telegram Bot Setup

Telegram (do this first):

1. In Telegram, message @BotFather → `/newbot` → pick a name + username (must end in `bot`)
2. Send `/newbot`
3. Pick a name (the display name, anything you like) — e.g. `My Client Finder`
4. Pick a username (must be unique and end in `bot`) — e.g. `myclientfinder_bot`

5. Copy the token it gives you (looks like `7123456789:AAH1a2...`) → paste into n8n's Telegram credential
6. In n8n: Credentials → click New → search and select Telegram API → paste your token into the Access Token field → click Save → then attach this credential to every Telegram node.
7. Attach this credential to every Telegram node across all 9 workflows
8. Get your chat ID: message @userinfobot → copy the number (you'll need it in Section 12)

Test: message your bot `/start` (it won't fully reply until everything's active — that's normal).

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09. Configure AI Model

The whole system uses one AI provider: OpenAI. 🎯

1. Go to platform.openai.com → API keys → Create new secret key → copy it
2. Add $5–10 billing credit (real usage is pennies per chat)
3. n8n: Credentials → New → OpenAI → paste key → Save
4. Attach this OpenAI credential to the AI model node in these 3 workflows:
    - Main Bot
    - Follow-up Reminders
    - Discovery Call Prep

💡 *On n8n Cloud, the model node may already show "n8n credits" and work with no key needed. If you see this, you can skip adding your own OpenAI key for now. Add it later if you want to use your own quota.*

💡 Bot acting odd after a very long conversation? Send start over, or startover,or /start over, or /startover to clear its memory.

🧠 *About the bot's memory*

The bot remembers the last several messages of your chat so it can hold a natural conversation. This short-term memory clears by itself over time as older messages drop off — so it always stays fresh on its own.

You can also clear it instantly: send `start over` in Telegram. The bot wipes the current conversation and confirms with a message.

Either way — whether you reset it or not — the memory clears. Resetting is just the manual, instant version.

⚠️ *This only clears the conversation. Your saved profile and leads are permanent (they live in the Data Table and Google Sheet) and are never affected.*

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10. Configure Databases

Your CRM is a Google Sheet.

1. Go to sheets.google.com → Blank spreadsheet
2. Rename the bottom tab to `prospects` (all lowercase,exactly this spelling)
3. In cell A1, paste this header row (each item in its own column):

```
lead_id  contact_name  company  domain  contact_email  linkedin_url
status  notes  research_brief  followup_stage  next_followup_at
last_contacted_at  call_at  call_prep_sent  chat_id  created_at
```

4. n8n: Credentials → New → Google Sheets OAuth2 → Sign in with Google
5. In each Google Sheets node, set Document to your spreadsheet and Sheet to `prospects`

Workflows that use the sheet: Save Lead, Follow-up Reminders, Discovery Call Prep, Update Lead Status.

Your profile is stored in a Data Table.

Separate from the Sheet, the bot keeps your business profile in an n8n Data Table. You must create it once:

1. *In n8n, open Data Tables (left sidebar) → Create Data Table*
2. *Name it exactly `user_profile`*
3. *Add these 12 columns (name → type):*

Column	*Type*
chat_id	*String*
full_name	*String*
phone	*String*
portfolio	*String*
profession	*String*
services	*String*
ideal_client	*String*

usp	*String*
voice	*String*
extra_notes	*String*
mem_version	*Number*
profile_updated_at	*Date*

4. *After creating the Data Table, open the Main Bot workflow → find the Get Profile node → click it → re-select your new user_profile table from the dropdown. Then open the Save Profile workflow → find the Upsert Profile node(the Data Table node that saves or updates your profile) → re-select your user_profile table from the dropdown. .*

ℹ️ *This is the only Data Table you need. Everything else (your leads) lives in the Google Sheet above*

You can also tell the bot to update your profile (`user_profile`) if you want to update anything

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11. Configure Webhooks

Two workflows talk to external services via authenticated requests:

Google Places (lead discovery):

1. console.cloud.google.com → New Project → name it → Create
2. Enable "Places API (New)"
3. Billing → link a card ($200/mo free)
4. Credentials → Create Credentials → API key → copy it
5. n8n: Credentials → New → Header Auth
    - Name: `Google Maps API`
    - Header Name: `X-Goog-Api-Key` ← must be exact
    - Header Value: your key
6. Attach it to the find_leads node in the Main Bot

⚠️ Most common mistake: using a plain "API key" credential. It must be Header Auth with header name `X-Goog-Api-Key`.

Gmail (sending outreach):

1. n8n: Credentials → New → Gmail OAuth2 → Sign in with Google
2. Attach to the Send Email node in: *Send Email with Approval* and *Follow-up Reminders*

ScrapingBee (optional — only for JS-heavy sites):

1. Sign up at scrapingbee.com → copy API key
2. n8n: Credentials → New → Query Auth → Name: `api_key`, Value: your key
3. Attach to the Fetch Rendered node in *Scrape Contact*

Jina AI Reader (no setup needed): This is a free fallback service built into the Scrape Contact workflow. It automatically extracts text from websites that block regular scrapers. No API key, no account, no cost — it works automatically. [

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12. Configure Variables

Replace the built-in defaults with your own details:

a) Your name in emails
Open Follow-up Reminders → Draft Follow-up node → System Message → replace `[Alex]` with your real name → Save.

b) Your chat ID for error alerts
Open Error Notifier → Send Error Alert node → replace `YOUR_TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID` with your number from @userinfobot → Save.

c) Your timezone
Open Discovery Call Prep → Filter Call Window node → find `const TIMEZONE = 'Asia/Calcutta'` → change to yours (e.g. `America/New_York`, `Europe/London`) → Save.

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13. First Test Run

⚠️ You must Publish ALL 9 workflows. If Save Lead or Send Email is not published, the Main Bot will fail when it tries to use them.

Activate(publish) the workflows in THIS order (helpers first, main bot last):

1. Save Lead
2. Scrape Contact
3. Send Email with Approval
4. Update Lead Status
5. Save Profile
6. Error Notifier
7. Follow-up Reminders
8. Discovery Call Prep
9. Main Bot — LAST

After publishing, open each helper workflow → ··· → Settings → Error workflow → select your Error Notifier.

Optional — Link Error Alerts

Your Error Notifier sends you a Telegram message when a workflow crashes.

To make it work, open each helper workflow → ··· → Settings → Error workflow → select "Error Notifier".

If it already shows "Error Notifier", skip it. If you skip this step, the bot still works — you just won't get crash alerts.

⚠️ Webhook rule: only the Main Bot listens to Telegram. If you click "Listen for test event" in the editor, it steals the connection — click Stop listening or refresh when done.

Now set up your profile. Message your bot:

hi

Then reply in one message with your profession, services, USP, ideal client, and voice. Example:

Graphic designer. Logo design, brand identity, social media graphics. USP: 48-hour turnaround, unlimited revisions. Ideal clients: small cafes, gyms, boutique shops. Voice: friendly and casual.

Then try:

- `find marketing agencies in Austin`
- `research the first one or tell me about that agency and their contact details`
- `save that lead`
- `draft an outreach email`

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14. Expected Results

When everything's working:

- `find …` → returns a list of real businesses with name, category, rating, website, phone, address, hours, and a fit score (0–100 vs your profile)
- `research the first one` → a full profile: what they do + emails + social links + phone
- `save that lead` → "Saved to your pipeline. First follow-up scheduled in 3 days."
- `draft an outreach email` → a personalized draft in your voice
- Ask it to send → you get a Telegram message with ✅ Send / ❌ Cancel buttons. Nothing is emailed until you tap Send.
- Each morning at 9am, due follow-ups arrive in Telegram for your approval

14.5 Discovery Call Prep (Optional)

This workflow runs automatically every 15 minutes. It checks if you have a client call scheduled in the next 45 minutes and sends you a prep brief in Telegram.

How it knows which client to prep for:

It reads your Google Sheet prospects tab and looks for any lead where:

- The call_at column has a date and time

- That time is within the next 45 minutes from right now

- call_prep_sent is blank (hasn't been prepped yet)

How to use it:

1. Open your Google Sheet prospects tab

2. Find the lead you have a call with

3. In the call_at column, type the call date and time (example format: 2026-08-10 14:30)

4. Make sure call_prep_sent is blank for that row

5. The workflow will automatically send you a prep brief in Telegram before the call

What the prep brief includes:

- What the company does (refreshed from their website)

- Likely pain points

- Suggested opening line

- Discovery questions to ask- Your USP to mention

After it sends the brief, it marks call_prep_sent as true so you don't get duplicate prep messages.⚠️ Important: You must manually enter the call time in the sheet. The bot does not schedule calls automatically.

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15. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Bot is silent	Main Bot isn't published, or "Listen for test event" is on. Only one Telegram webhook is allowed.
"Workflow not published"	A helper workflow is off — make sure all 9 are published.
No leads found	Places API not enabled, billing off, or wrong credential type (must be Header Auth with `X-Goog-Api-Key`).
Leads won't save	Sheet not connected, tab not named `prospects`, or headers missing in Row 1.
Emails won't send	Reconnect Gmail OAuth2.
No social links found	Site is JS-rendered — add ScrapingBee (Section 11).
Bot repeating old info	Send `start over`.

Error alerts not arriving	Wrong chat ID in Error Notifier — use the number from @userinfobot.
Email signed with wrong name	Redo Section 12a.
No call prep received	Make sure you entered the date/time in the call_at column (format:YYYY-MM-DD HH:mm) and that call_prep_sent is blank.

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16. Common Errors

Error message	Meaning & fix
`401 / Unauthorized` (leads)	Google API key wrong or Places API not enabled. Re-check Section 11.
`403 / billing not enabled`	Turn on billing in Google Cloud.
`Gmail: insufficient permissions`	Reconnect Gmail OAuth2 and grant send access.
`chat not found`	Wrong/empty chat ID. Use your @userinfobot number.
`Workflow could not be started`	A helper workflow is inactive — activate all 9.

Bot gives odd/looping replies	Poisoned short-term memory — send `start over`

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17. Customization Guide

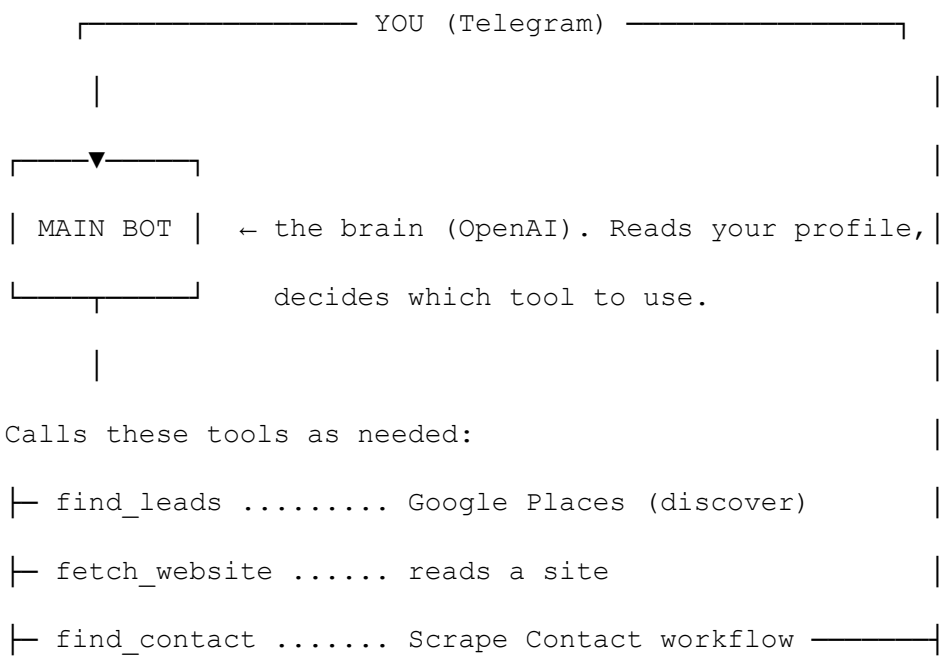
Easy tweaks you can make:

- Change the AI's personality/tone → Main Bot → *Assistant* node → System Message
- Change follow-up timing (default 3 → 7 → 14 days) → Follow-up Reminders → *Prepare Reminders* code node
- Change the daily reminder time (default 9am) → Follow-up Reminders → *Daily 9am* trigger
- Change email styling → Send Email with Approval → *Send Email* node (the HTML block)
- Add more lead detail → Main Bot → *find_leads* node → the `X-Goog-FieldMask` header

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18. Workflow Architecture

How it fits together:



```
   ├─ save_lead .......... Save Lead workflow ──────────────┤
   ├─ save_profile ....... Save Profile workflow            │
   ├─ update_lead_status . Update Lead Status workflow      │
   └─ send_email ......... Send Email w/ Approval ──────────┘ (asks you
first)


   Runs on their own schedule (no chat needed):
   ├─ Follow-up Reminders .. daily 9am
   ├─ Discovery Call Prep .. every 15 min
   └─ Error Notifier ....... fires only if something breaks
```

- CRM: Google Sheet (`prospects` tab)
- AI: OpenAI across all three thinking workflows
- Approval: every client-facing email waits for your ✅

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19. Updating the Workflow

To update to a newer version I release:

1. Export/back up your current workflows (··· → Download) so you keep your settings
2. Import the new JSON files (Section 06)
3. Re-attach your credentials (they don't transfer inside the file — this is by design, for your security)
4. Re-apply your variables (Section 12)
5. Activate in order (Section 13)

Your Google Sheet CRM data is untouched by updates.

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20. FAQ

Q: Will it email clients without me knowing?
No. Every email shows you a draft with ✅ Send / ❌ Cancel first, and waits up to 24h. Nothing sends unless you approve.

Q: Can it read LinkedIn/Instagram profiles?
No. It can capture a public *link* to those profiles if it's on a website, but it cannot read inside them (they require login). No tool can do this legally.

Q: Does it make up information?
No — it's specifically instructed to only report facts that come from a live tool result, and to say "not found" rather than guess.

Q: How much does it cost to run?
Typically $0–5/month. Google gives $200/mo free, OpenAI is pennies per chat, everything else has a free tier.

Q: Can I change the AI model?
Yes — edit the credential/model on the OpenAI nodes. The guide assumes OpenAI throughout.

Q: How do I stop follow-ups for a client I already spoke to?
Just tell the bot, e.g. "I already talked to Acme" or "Acme signed" — it updates the status and stops chasing.

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21. Support

Need help? DM me on Reddit — same username you got this from.

Please include: what you tried, the exact error message, and a screenshot if possible.

This is a free beta copy. I will do my best to help you get it running.